

Saturday, 15 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 28° 21°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 24° 16°	MANCHESTER Overcast 22° 15°	GLASGOW Overcast 18° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Two men have been charged following an alleged attack on Sara Sharif's father in Belmarsh Prison.

Steven Sansom and Adam Watson face charges including assault occasioning actual bodily harm. The incident occurred while Sharif's father, Urfan Sharif, was awaiting trial for the murder of his daughter.

CRIME · UK
- 2

The government has announced a temporary ban on the sale of disposable BBQs due to the ongoing heatwave and wildfire risk.

Officials warn that single-use grills pose a 'significant risk to the public' in the current dry conditions. The move aims to prevent further devastating blazes across the country.

ENVIRONMENT · UK
- 3

A mother has been jailed for killing her three-month-old baby by burning her with a hairdryer.

Courtney Gartshore subjected Dahlia-Rose to 'significant and sustained heat' on her head and body. The court heard the horrific details of the infant's death.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Over one million people have signed a petition to keep PC Andrew Harper's killers in jail.

The milestone was reached ahead of the anniversary of the officer's death, highlighting continued public concern. The petition calls for tougher sentences for those who kill emergency service workers.

JUSTICE · UK
- 5

Disability campaigners are urging Greater Manchester Mayor Andy Burnham to delay his proposed assisted dying bill.

Activists argue that introducing assisted dying without first reforming social care places 'sick and disabled people's lives at risk'. They believe adequate support must be in place first.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The full line-up for Strictly Come Dancing 2026 has finally been announced!**

Gwen from the BBC sitcom 'Gavin & Stacey', Melanie Walters, is the 15th and final celebrity to join the show. Fans are already speculating about who will lift the Glitterball trophy.

ON AIR – Who are you most excited to see on the dancefloor this year, and do you think Melanie Walters has a shot?

TV · AUTUMN 2026
- 2 Horror maestro Mike Flanagan is joining Henry Cavill on the highly anticipated Warhammer adaptations.**

Games Workshop, the creators of the popular tabletop hobby, confirmed that Flanagan will be working on scripts for the new series. This is big news for fans of both the director and the fantasy universe.

ON AIR – Are you a Warhammer fan, and what are your hopes for this big-screen adaptation?

FILM · FUTURE
- 3 The trailer for 'Children of Blood and Bone' is out, starring Cynthia Erivo and Damson Idris!**

The blockbuster film is based on Tomi Adeyemi's bestselling novel, though the author has distanced herself from the adaptation. It looks set to be a huge fantasy epic.

ON AIR – Have you read the book, and does the trailer live up to your expectations for this big fantasy adventure?

FILM · FUTURE
- 4 Rapper Aitch has revealed how his sister inspired him to climb one of the world's toughest peaks.**

He's been taking on various challenges to raise money and awareness for the Down's Syndrome Association. It's a really personal and inspiring journey for the star.

ON AIR – What's the most challenging thing you've ever done for a good cause?

MUSIC · CHARITY
- 5 The popular football game EA FC has received a new age rating after changes to loot box rules.**

The game's 'Ultimate Team' mode now earns it a 16+ rating from the age ratings board PEGI. This reflects growing concerns over in-game purchases.

ON AIR – Do you think the new 16+ rating for EA FC is a good move, especially with children playing these games?

GAMING · FUTURE

On the schedule

- 1 **It's a pivotal day for Chelsea and Manchester City as the deadline for an Enzo Fernandez bid looms.**
Chelsea's offer for the midfielder must be on the table by 5 PM BST on Friday. Will the deal happen, or will the transfer saga continue?
ON AIR – Do you think Fernandez will end up at Chelsea, or will Manchester City manage to snatch him at the last minute?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 2 **The new football season is set to introduce an unprecedented number of new rules, tackling VAR, timewasting, and substitutions.**
These changes are mostly designed to speed up the game and reduce disruptions. It could significantly alter how matches are played.
ON AIR – Are you looking forward to these new football rules, or do you think they'll just cause more confusion?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 3 **Great Britain's Katarina Johnson-Thompson has boosted her heptathlon medal hopes at the European Athletics Championships.**
She delivered a strong high jump performance, putting her in a great position for a medal. All eyes will be on her as the competition continues.
ON AIR – How do you rate Katarina Johnson-Thompson's chances of bringing home a medal for Great Britain?
ATHLETICS · UK

- 4 **Tanzid Hasan Tamim has made history, scoring Bangladesh's first-ever Test century in Australia.**
The cricketer's impressive performance came on day two in Darwin as the visitors continued to dominate. It's a huge milestone for Bangladeshi cricket.
ON AIR – What a moment for Bangladesh! Do you think this century marks a turning point for their Test cricket team?
CRICKET · GLOBAL

- 5 **Amy Hunt is aiming for more gold after her stunning 200m victory at the European Athletics Championships.**
The GB sprint star secured her second gold medal, but stressed that 'it's not over yet' as she looks forward to the sprint relays. She's certainly making her mark!
ON AIR – Amy Hunt is on fire! Do you think she can achieve a historic quadruple and grab even more gold?
ATHLETICS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A study has found that the comforting sight of 'steam rising from a hot drink' can significantly boost feelings of relaxation.**
Researchers suggest that this simple visual cue, combined with the warmth and aroma, contributes to a sense of calm and well-being. It's a small moment of peace in our busy days.
- 2 The trend of 'repurposing old furniture' for new uses is becoming incredibly popular across the country.**
From old chests of drawers becoming plant stands to vintage suitcases turning into pet beds, people are showing incredible creativity in giving beloved items a second life.
- 3 A delightful movement encouraging 'community seed swapping' has blossomed in local areas.**
Gardeners are sharing their excess seeds, fostering biodiversity and connecting with neighbours over a shared love of growing things. It's a wonderful way to grow your garden for free!
- 4 New research indicates that 'listening to the sound of distant church bells' can evoke strong feelings of nostalgia and comfort.**
For many, the gentle chimes are a reminder of simpler times and community, acting as a subtle stress reliever in our modern lives.
- 5 The charming practice of 'decorating front doors' according to the seasons or holidays is seeing a lovely resurgence.**
Beyond Christmas wreaths, people are adding unique touches for spring, summer, and autumn, bringing a splash of joy and personality to their neighbourhoods.
- 6 An increasing number of people are discovering the quiet joy of 'birdwatching from their own windows'.**
Setting up feeders and observing the local feathered visitors provides a peaceful connection to nature, even in urban environments. All you need is a comfy chair and a cuppa!
- 7 A heartwarming initiative has seen communities coming together to 'create painted stones' and hide them for others to find.**
These colourful little treasures, often with uplifting messages, bring unexpected smiles and a sense of shared discovery to parks and pathways across the UK.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our perfectly good teabags, even though we know we probably shouldn't?

ANSWER: USING IT FOR A SECOND CUP OF TEA, JUST TO GET A LITTLE BIT MORE OUT OF IT!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh packet of biscuits. What is it?

ANSWER: CAREFULLY ARRANGING THEM INTO A PERFECTLY SYMMETRICAL PATTERN ON A PLATE, EVEN IF YOU'RE THE ONLY ONE EATING THEM!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'smell from your childhood' can instantly transport you back in time?**

What's that one scent – maybe fresh-cut grass, your mum's baking, or even an old book – that takes you straight back to a happy memory? Give us a call and share your nostalgic smells!

- **We all have those 'little rituals' we perform before embarking on a journey, whether it's a daily commute or a grand adventure.**

Do you always check for your keys three times? Or perhaps you have a special playlist for the car? What are your quirky little pre-journey habits? We'd love to hear them!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** Did you know that there are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on all the beaches on Earth?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that if you whisper a secret into the ear of a squirrel, it will carry your message to the trees, which then pass it on to the wind.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, weighing less than a penny.
- A group of owls is called a parliament, thanks to their wise and serious appearance.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The distinctive sound of the Wilhelm Scream has been used in over 400 films and TV shows since 1951.
- A 'floccinaucinihilipilification' is the act or habit of estimating something as worthless.
- The first ever recorded traffic light was installed in London in 1868, near the Houses of Parliament.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow, a fun fact often shared to prove a point!

On this day

Day 227 of the year, 138 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Poland); Christian feast day: Altfrid; Christian feast day: Alypius of Thagaste; Christian feast day: Feast day of the Assumption of Mary, one of the Catholic holy days of obligation (a public holiday in Austria, Belgium, Benin, Bosnia, Burundi, Cameroon, Chile, Colombia, Croatia, Cyprus, France, some states in Germany, Greece, Guatemala, Italy, Ivory Coast, Lebanon, Liechtenstein, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Madagascar, Malta, Mauritius, Paraguay, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Senegal, Seychelles, Slovenia, Spain, Switzerland, Togo, and Vanuatu); and its related observances: Feast of the Dormition of the Theotokos (Eastern Orthodox, Oriental Orthodox and Eastern Catholic Churches). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1972 — Ben Affleck, American actor and filmmaker
- 1948 — Tom Johnston, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1985 — Nipsey Hussle, American rapper (died 2019)
- 1938 — Stix Hooper, American jazz drummer
- 1958 — Rondell Sheridan, American actor and comedian
- 1933 — Bobby Helms, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1997)
- 1946 — Jimmy Webb, American singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1950 — Tess Harper, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 2025 — US president Donald Trump meets with Russian president Vladimir Putin in Alaska, the first such summit since the 2022 Russian invasion of Ukraine.
- 2020 — Russia begins production on the Sputnik V COVID-19 vaccine.
- 2021 — Kabul falls into the hands of the Taliban as Ashraf Ghani flees Afghanistan along with local residents and foreign nationals, effectively reestablishing the Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1882 — Start of the second part of the Montceau-les-Mines troubles by the Black Band, groups of anarchist miners.
- 1995 — In South Carolina, Shannon Faulkner becomes the first female cadet matriculated at The Citadel (she drops out less than a week later).

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2021 — Kabul falls into the hands of the Taliban as Ashraf Ghani flees Afghanistan along with local residents and foreign nationals, effectively reestablishing the Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan.
- 2007 — An 8.0-magnitude earthquake off the Pacific coast devastates Ica and various regions of Peru killing 514 and injuring 1,090.
- 1998 — Northern Ireland: Omagh bombing takes place; 29 people (including a woman pregnant with twins) killed and some 220 others injured.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 228 of the year, 137 days left in 2026. Today Bennington Battle Day (Vermont, United States); Children's Day (Paraguay); Christian feast day: Ana Petra Pérez Florido; Christian feast day: Armel (Armagillus). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1997 — Greyson Chance, American musician
- 1993 — Cameron Monaghan, American actor and model
- 1962 — Steve Carell, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1948 — Joey Spampinato, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1980 — Vanessa Carlton, American singer-songwriter
- 1942 — Robert Squirrel Lester, American soul singer (died 2010)
- 1957 — Laura Innes, American actress and director
- 1979 — Paul Gallacher, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2015 — Trigana Air Flight 267, an ATR 42, crashes in Oksibil, Bintang Mountains Regency, killing all 54 people on board.
- 1960 — Cyprus gains its independence from the United Kingdom.
- 2005 — West Caribbean Airways Flight 708, a McDonnell Douglas MD-82, crashes in Machiques, Venezuela, killing all 160 people on board.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Australian Prime Minister Gough Whitlam symbolically hands over land to the Gurindji people after the eight-year Wave Hill walk-off, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 song by Paul Kelly and an annual celebration.
- 2008 — The Trump International Hotel and Tower in Chicago is topped off at 1,389 feet (423 m), at the time becoming the world's highest residence above ground-level.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)